

# Introduction to Linguistics, Language and Communication

## Unit 1, Class 1

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## Section 1

# Today's plan



# The plan

- Know each other
- Class rules
- Syllabus discussion
- What is communication?



# Know your instructor

**Pratik Bhandari, PhD** from Bhadrapur (Chandragadhi), Jhapa



# Let's agree

To:

- Ask me questions, a lot of questions
  - in class or email
- Answer my questions
- Notify at least two days in advance to postpone the class
- Submit assignments on time
- Engage in constructive discussion, not just listening to the *lecture*



# Class and syllabus

- Basics of **Linguistics** will be covered in this course
- Nepali and Nepali languages
- A paper to read and an assignment after every alternate unit
- Paper discussion



# What do we have in Unit 1?

- 1 Define communication and describe nature and types of communication
- 2 List out differences between human language and animal communication systems
- 3 Define language and describe nature, properties and functions of language
- 4 Describe sub-systems of language
- 5 Explain relation between language and society
- 6 Define linguistics and describe branches and scope of linguistics





# What is communication?

- Origin: Latin verb *communicare*, which means “to share” or “to make common”
- When we communicate, we make things common

What kind of things?



# Define communication

- Exchange of information, idea, or *message* between two (or more) entities, individuals, or groups through a **common** system of symbols, signs, or behavior
- Components:
  - Sender
  - Receiver
  - Medium (or channel)
  - Message



# Communication: Discuss

- Does communication take place across more than two entities?
- Can unintentional transmission of information be considered communication?
- How do audiological and speech-language disorders affect communication?
- Are there components of communications other than sender, message, medium, and receiver?

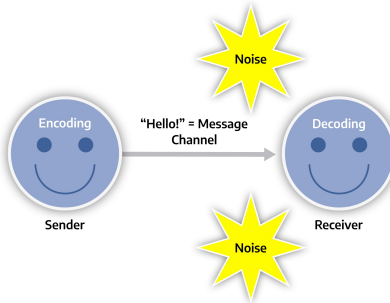


## Section 2

# Models of communication



# Linear model



**Figure 1:** Representation of a linear model.

# Linear model

- Message travels from sender to receiver through a medium, e.g., Shannon's noisy channel model (Shannon, 1948)
- Message is *encoded* by a Sender before transmitting it to the Receiver, who then *decodes* it on receiving
- Meaning is encoded in the message
- *Noise* in the medium or channel of transmission can impair communication



# Interaction model

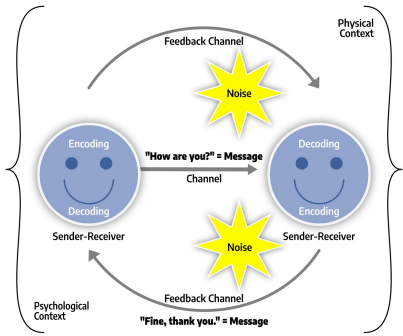


Figure 2: Representation of an interaction model.



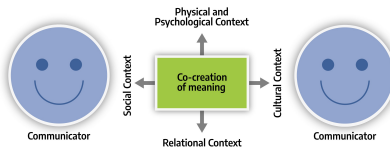
# Interaction model

- Receiver and Sender change roles
- They provide *feedback* to each other
- Interaction creates meaning
- Meaning is located not just in messages but in the social context, e.g., Schramm's model (Schramm, 1960)





# Transaction model



**Figure 3:** Representation of a transactional model.

# Transaction model

- Instant feedback while sending message(s)
- Sending, receiving, and responding are simultaneous processes
- Social, relational, and cultural contexts give meaning to the message



## Section 3

# Functions and characteristics of communication



# Functions: Why do we communicate?

- 1 Physical or health needs
- 2 Instrumental needs
- 3 Relational needs
- 4 Social needs



# Physical or health needs

- Alerting others, e.g., babies cry to signal their discomfort, pain, and hunger
- Good interpersonal communication → lower level of depression and anxiety (Hargie, 2011)
- Not communicating during emotional trauma (e.g., after a loss) → physical symptoms like weight changes and headaches (Greene et al., 2006)



# Instrumental needs

- To get things done to achieve short- and long-term goals
- Play a key role in influencing others, gathering information, and seeking support (Burleson et al., 2000)
- Most of our communication is to fulfil instrumental needs



# Relational needs

- Help us form, maintain, and end social bonds and interpersonal relationships (Altman & Taylor, 1973)
- Closeness and intimacy may vary, but all individuals have relational needs, which communications helps to fill and form
- Providing support, encouragement, celebration, and so on builds relationships



# Characteristics of communication

- 1 Success is rare
- 2 Occurs verbally and nonverbally
- 3 Is continuous
- 4 Has ethical implications
- 5 Is culturally specific
- 6 Reflects personality





## Section 4

# Types of Communication



# Based on settings

- 1 Intrapersonal communication
- 2 Interpersonal communication
- 3 Small group communication
- 4 Public communication
- 5 Computer mediated communication



# Intrapersonal communication

- Communicating with oneself
- May not fit the definition of communication but affects all other types of communication

Do you hear yourself commenting on this definition?



# Interpersonal communication

- Most common form
- Two people communicating with one another
- Basis of human relationships and self-image



# Group communication

- Generally works together to complete a goal (Powerll, 1996)
- Requires acceptance, not necessarily agreement
- Ideally, all members (should) have equal power
- Members form coalition and may hinder or promote communication
- Ideal group should not have more than 5 members (Bormann & Bormann, 1980)



# Public communication

- *One-to-many* with speaker carrying higher responsibility for a successful communication, i.e., sending information to the audience (Beebe & Beebe, 2021)
- Limited verbal feedback from the audience
- Unidirectional communication

Is this lecture public or small group communication?



# Computer mediated communication (CMC)

- Occurs through the use of computer and information technology
- Communicate globally in virtually any language
- Cognitive consequences in attention

What percentage of your communication CMC?



# Based on party involved

- 1 Sender-based communication
- 2 Receiver-based communication





# Sender-based communication

- Sender acts egocentrically
- Assumes that - their way of communication is appropriate for everyone - what is said is communicated - miscommunication is others' fault
- Sender-based listener assumes how they interpret the message is how the sender intended it
- Absolute, self-centered, and non-adaptive approach to communication



# Receiver-based communication

- Sender customises the communication for specific receiver
- They work to offset misunderstandings and misinterpretations from the beginning
- They can move among a broader range of relationships (e.g., children and older adults), adapting to diversity far more effectively

Self-reflexive?



# Based on species & entities involved

- ① Human communication
- ② Animal communication
- ③ Plant communication
- ④ Human-animal communication
- ⑤ Machine to machine (M2M) communication



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